QUICK INCIDENT RESPONSE CHECKLIST

This checklist provides a streamlined guide for responding to cybersecurity incidents (e.g., data breaches, unauthorized access). Refer to the full Incident Response Plan for detailed procedures. and definitions.

1. DETECTION AND REPORTING

- **Identify Incident:** Note signs like phishing emails, system alerts, or consumer complaints about unauthorized credit activity.
- **Report Immediately:** Contact Cybersecurity Advisor ([Name], [email], [phone] or Technical Team Lead ([Name], [email], [phone]) within 30 - 60 minutes. Inform CEO within 60 - 120 minutes after incident has been fully verified.
- **Document Details:** Record date, time, description, and affected systems/data using the Incident Report Template.
- **Escalate:** Cybersecurity Advisor assesses severity and notifies Legal Department if regulatory reporting is required.

2. CONTAINMENT

- **Isolate Systems:** Technical Team disconnects affected devices or networks to limit spread (e.g., disable network access).
- **Preserve Evidence:** Avoid altering affected systems; save logs or screenshots for investigation. Do not power down any systems, networks, or cloud instances. These can be hold valuable forensic artifacts in memory which will be lost during a power down.
- **Implement Short-Term Fixes:** Apply temporary measures (e.g., disable compromised accounts, block suspicious IP addresses, devices, or accounts).
- **Notifications:** Contact affected system owners, clients, or third-parties regarding the incident. Work with legal, HR, CEO, and the IT/security team for notification templates and procedures.

3. INVESTIGATION AND RECOVERY

- **Analyze Root Cause:** Cybersecurity Advisor and Technical Team investigate to identify the incident source.
- **Eradicate Threats:** Remove malware, patch vulnerabilities, or reset credentials as needed. If the incident was a false positive, test and develop work-arounds / mitigations for future occurrences. Configure the tech stack so it is less likely to cause a similar incident in the future.
- **Restore Systems:** Technical Team verifies system integrity and restores from secure backups.
- **Notify Stakeholders:** Legal Department drafts consumer/regulatory notifications; CEO approves external communications.

4. POST-INCIDENT

- **Conduct Review:** Cybersecurity Advisor leads a IR review within 7 days, documenting lessons learned. Advisor will develop tabletop scenarios to train employees and partners how to respond to incidents.
- **Update Plan:** Propose improvements to processes or training based on findings.
- **Report to Regulators:** Legal Department submits required reports (e.g., FTC, CFPB) within 30-60 days, if applicable.